PILOT AUTHORISATION TEMPLATE

AI Data Centre Facilities Assurance Framework: pilot pack

Version 1.0

The authorisation record a host completes and signs before an AIDCF mini-pilot may start

Artifact ID: AIDCF-PIL-002 Artifact type: Pilot record template Status: Draft for controlled review Author: Siva Sethumadhavan

> **Pilot status: pack ready; no authorised pilot has taken place.** This is a blank template. A copy becomes an authorisation only when completed and signed by the named parties.

> **Legal review required.** This template is not legal advice and has not been reviewed for any jurisdiction. Before anyone signs it, the host's legal adviser must review it (and, where a separate organisation provides the assessment team or the facility, that organisation's legal adviser too), adapt it to the applicable law, contracts, data-protection and confidentiality obligations and insurance, and decide whether it is to be a contract, a memorandum of understanding or an internal authorisation. Nothing in it overrides the host's own policies, permits or statutory duties.

Document control

Field	Value
Document ID	AIDCF-PIL-002
Title	AIDCF Pilot Authorisation Template
Version	1.0
Date	2026-10-11
Status	Draft for controlled review
Author	Siva Sethumadhavan
Used with	AIDCF-PIL-001 Mini-Pilot Protocol (conditions C1–C10, PIL-REQ-001 to PIL-REQ-016); AIDCF-PIL-003 Evidence Request List; AIDCF-009 Part A WP-01, WP-03, WP-05 and B14; whitepaper §29.1 and §29.4

Revision history

Version	Date	Summary
1.0	2026-10-11	First issue.

How to complete this template

- Complete every field. A field that does not apply is marked "n/a" with a reason; a blank is not "not applicable" (AIDCF-009 §E).
- Square brackets show what to enter. Tick boxes are completed `[x]` or `[ ]` with a note where not ticked.
- The completed record is classified at least **Confidential** (AIDCF-012 Part XIII). It is held by the host and the lead assessor and is never committed to the public AIDCF repository.
- The completed record is the SG0 input. WP-01 (Assessment Charter) is prepared from it and must not contradict it.

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1. Pilot identification

Field	Entry
Pilot ID	PILOT-001 (or the next free identifier in the AIDCF pilot register)
Host pilot reference	[host reference]
Host organisation	[legal name; this field is never published without §12 approval]
Assessment team organisation(s)	[legal name(s)]
Programme model (AIDCF-011 Part III)	[first-party / co-sourced / second-party / independent provider]
Assessment type (AIDCF-011 Part V)	Implementation (AL3) or Operational (AL4)
Protocol version applied	AIDCF-PIL-001 v1.0
AIDCF artifact versions (AMH-REQ-005)	AIDCF-007A registry [v1.1]; AIDCF-008 [v1.1]; AIDCF-009 Part A [v1.1]; AIDCF-010 [v1.1]; AIDCF-011 [v1.1]; AIDCF-012 [v1.1]
Starter Profile	`pilots/pilot-framework/starter-profile.csv` at repository commit [hash], verified with `--check` on [date]
Planned dates	SG0 [date]; fieldwork [from–to]; SG6 [date]; SG7 [date]

2. Sponsor, capability owner and decision authority

2.1 Sponsor authorisation

Field	Entry
Sponsor name and role	[name, post]
Authority	[delegation or instrument under which the sponsor authorises the decision question, scope, resources and access]
Resources committed	[host staff and time; facilities; budget, if any]
Sponsor statement	"I authorise the AIDCF mini-pilot described in this record, within the scope, rules of engagement and terms stated, and I commit the host resources listed. I understand that the maximum permissible decision under this scope is LIMITED (§4.3)."

2.2 Capability owner

Field	Entry
Capability owner name and role	[name, post]
Capability Instance owned	[identifier and name]
Variant B provider owners (if any)	[for each provided power or cooling service: provider, accountable person, agreement reference]
Same person as sponsor?	[yes/no; if yes, reason (PIL-REQ-003)]
Capability owner statement	"I confirm ownership of the Capability Instance and its Service Outcomes, approve the scope and evidence access in this record, and accept the stop right in §7."

2.3 Decision authority

Field	Entry
Decision authority name and role	[name, post]
Authority for the decision question	[instrument or delegation]
Independence from the assessment team	[basis; must satisfy GC-13-6 and AIDCF-009 A4]
Decision authority statement	"I will issue the Assurance Decision after independent review, or record a decision not to issue one. I will not select a state above the maximum permissible state derived under AIDCF-010 (SDF-REQ-024)."

3. Scope and boundary

Field	Entry
Capability Instance	[identifier; one cluster or partition and its supporting systems]
Boundary variant (AIDCF-PIL-001 §3.1)	[A integrated / B tenant in a facility]
Physical boundary	[buildings, rooms, plant areas; described at a level that is itself Confidential]
Logical boundary	[cluster, scheduler, storage tiers, fabrics, management and out-of-band networks, control systems]
Organisational boundary	[owner, operator, estates or facilities function, providers and their responsibilities]
Temporal boundary	[assessment date; evidence period]
Operating states in scope	[as per profile stateCoverage; typically NORMAL, MAINTENANCE, DEGRADED, EMERGENCY, RECOVERY]
External dependencies to be recorded under CG-03	[utility, telecom, cloud and service, OEM, sub-tier suppliers]
Exclusions	[each with rationale, Service Outcomes it can affect and decision effect (AMH-REQ-020); always including the 302 registry controls outside the Starter Profile]

Field	Entry
Areas the pilot team will not enter	[list]

4. Decision question, target Assurance Level and reachable decision

4.1 Decision question

Field	Entry
Decision question	[the question the named decision user needs answered]
Top claim (AIDCF-009 §0.5)	"Capability Instance [X] can achieve Service Outcomes [Y] within tolerances [T] under declared operating states [S], for decision question [Q], as of date [D]."
Service Outcomes (preliminary)	[availability, performance, integrity, recovery outcomes with metric and tolerance, to be finalised in WP-02]
Named decision user(s) and intended use	[who will use the output, for what]
Prohibited interpretation	[for example: "The output is not a certification, an engineering or safety approval, or a statement about any system outside the boundary; it does not assess life safety, failure containment, change control, responsibility and authority, digital authority, or compute/storage/network functional integrity."]

4.2 Target Assurance Level

Field	Entry
Target AL	[AL3 (recommended) / AL4 (only where twelve months of operating records will be shared)]
Claim types concluded	[DESIGN, IMPLEMENTATION] or [DESIGN, IMPLEMENTATION, OPERATION]
Mandatory control-claims	[107 at AL3; 138 at AL4]
Freeze	The target AL is frozen at SG1 and is not changed after the first control result is recorded (PIL-REQ-004; SDF-REQ-008).

4.3 Gates and the reachable decision (PIL-REQ-006)

Gate	Pilot scope	Ceiling if UNKNOWN or NOT_ASSESSED
CG-01, CG-02, CG-03, CG-05, CG-06, CG-07, CG-10	Evaluated	Per registries/gates/critical-gates.csv
CG-11, CG-12	Evaluated (meta-gates over the profile)	Per registries/gates/critical-gates.csv
CG-04	NOT_ASSESSED	LIMITED for outcomes depending on the affected area
CG-08	NOT_ASSESSED	LIMITED for outcomes delivered by the cluster, fabric or storage tier
CG-09	NOT_ASSESSED	LIMITED for the decision as a whole

Gate	Pilot scope	Ceiling if UNKNOWN or NOT_ASSESSED
CG-13	NOT_ASSESSED	LIMITED
CG-14	NOT_ASSESSED	LIMITED
CG-15	NOT_ASSESSED	LIMITED; INCONCLUSIVE where an unverified authority reaches two or more other gates (US5)
Variant B only: CG-05 and/or CG-06	[APPROVED_NA only if the registry conditions are met; rationale and approver]	none

- ☐ The sponsor and decision user understand that the **maximum permissible decision is LIMITED**, and that NOT_ASSURED and INCONCLUSIVE are possible.
- ☐ The sponsor and decision user understand that gate criteria naming tests (GC-05-4, GC-05-6, GC-05-7, GC-06-4, GC-06-6, GC-07-3, GC-07-7, GC-10-3, GC-10-4, GC-10-5) can be met only from existing records, because the pilot performs no tests.

5. Research purpose

Field	Entry
Research lead	[name, organisation]
Research questions informed	[from AIDCF-PIL-001 §2.2]
Measures collected	PM-01 to PM-20 (AIDCF-PIL-001 §12.2)
Double assessment	About 20% of control-claims by a second assessor, blind; all evaluated Gate Results re-derived independently
Interviews and ratings used for research	[yes/no; scope]
Research ethics	[where the host or the research lead's institution requires ethics review for research involving people (interviews, usability and usefulness ratings): committee, reference and approval date; otherwise "not required" with the basis]
Participant information and consent	[how interviewees and raters are informed of research use and can decline, as determined by the host and ethics review]
Separation	Research measures never change a result, Gate Result or decision (AIDCF-PIL-001 §12.1).

6. Evidence access

Field	Entry
Evidence request list	AIDCF-PIL-003 and `evidence-request-list.csv` at the commit in §1
Host evidence coordinator	[name, role]
Controlled repository	[host-provided or host-approved system; location; access list]
Configuration extraction	[systems; executed by host operator and witnessed / executed by assessor with read-only credentials; change-process reference]
Systems excluded from extraction	[systems whose owner judges extraction could affect a controller or production workload; recorded as UNKNOWN (U2) or met by a listed acceptable alternative]

Field	Entry
Third-party evidence	[provider and OEM documents; redistribution restrictions; provider consent where needed]
Interview access	[roles available for interview; time per role]
Site access	[dates, escort, induction, areas]
Refusal handling	A refused or unavailable item is recorded as an UNKNOWN Record with type and severity, never treated as favourable (AMH-REQ-007).

7. Rules of engagement checklist

Built from AIDCF-009 B14 steps 1–6, B10, B13, AMH-REQ-026, AMH-REQ-029 and AMH-REQ-031. Each line is ticked and, where needed, completed.

7.1 Method risk and permits (B14 step 1)

- ☐ Every planned method is listed with its risk class: DOCUMENT_REVIEW, INQUIRY, ANALYSIS (none); OBSERVATION of walkthroughs, INSPECTION without contact (low); read-only configuration extraction (low to medium, system owner to classify per system).
- ☐ Permits, inductions and escorts required for each area visited are listed: [list].
- ☐ No method classed above the agreed level is planned.

7.2 Authorities (B14 step 2)

Authority	Name, role, contact
Safety authority (approves access and work; can stop any activity)	[entry]
Change authority (approves configuration extraction on production management interfaces)	[entry]
Stop authorities (anyone listed may stop pilot activity at any time)	Safety authority; capability owner; [others]
Host duty contact during fieldwork	[entry]

- ☐ The safety authority and capability owner have the right to stop any assessment activity at any time; a stop is recorded with its effect on results (AMH-REQ-031).

7.3 Communications, monitoring and rollback (B14 step 3)

- ☐ Fieldwork schedule shared with the host operations team in advance.
- ☐ Each configuration extraction is booked in the host's change or work-control process where required, with the system owner present or consulted.
- ☐ A rollback is defined for each extraction where the system owner requires one (normally: terminate session, revoke credential).
- ☐ Escalation route for any unexpected system behaviour during extraction: [entry].

7.4 Credentials and sensitive paths (B14 step 4)

- ☐ Pilot credentials are named, read-only, time-limited and listed: [list].

- ☐ No credential, key, network address, hostname or privileged route is written into workpapers, reports or messages; evidence is cited by evidence ID.
- ☐ HIGHLY_RESTRICTED evidence is reviewed only on host-controlled systems.

7.5 Deviations, incidents and near misses (B14 step 5)

- ☐ Any deviation from these rules, incident or near miss is reported to the safety authority immediately and recorded in the pilot log with its effect on results.

7.6 Close-out (B14 step 6)

- ☐ At SG7: credentials revoked, temporary access removed, any loaned equipment returned, and the host confirms the environment is as found.

7.7 Prohibited activities

The pilot team shall not:

1. operate, switch, isolate, open, adjust, reset or acknowledge alarms on any equipment (AMH-REQ-026);
2. perform or direct any test, failover, load bank, transfer, restoration, black-start or exercise on power, cooling, fire and life-safety systems, control systems or production AI workloads (AMH-REQ-029 is not engaged because no test is authorised);
3. run active network scanning, vulnerability scanning or penetration testing, or deploy taps, sensors or agents;
4. write to, change or upload to any controller, BMS, EPMS, CDU, PLC/SCADA system, network device, scheduler or storage system;
5. use credentials other than those issued for the pilot, or retain them after SG7;
6. remove evidence from the controlled repository, photograph areas where the host prohibits it, or copy HIGHLY_RESTRICTED material to any non-host system;
7. enter areas outside the approved route or without escort where escort is required;
8. operate controls, accept risk or make management decisions for the host (AMH-REQ-013);
9. present any pilot output as certification, accreditation, engineering approval or framework-owner endorsement (AIDCF-011 Part XIV);
10. carry out any activity not listed as permitted in this record (PIL-REQ-009).

8. Safety authority sign-off

Field	Entry
Safety authority	[name, role, authority]
Activities approved	[walkthrough routes; inspection areas; extraction systems and methods]
Conditions	[induction, PPE, escort, time windows, areas excluded]
Hazards briefed to the pilot team	[list or reference to host induction]
Statement	"I approve the activities listed, on the conditions stated, and I retain the right to stop any activity at any time."
Signature and date	[signature] [date]

9. Information classification and handling

Class (AIDCF-012 Part XIII)	SECURITY.md class	Pilot content	Handling agreed
Highly restricted	HIGHLY_RESTRICTED	Credentials, network addresses and paths, control-system configurations, privileged routes, physical routes, emergency procedures, exploitable weaknesses	Host systems only; need-to-know list: [names]
Confidential	CONFIDENTIAL	Architecture, evidence, workpapers, findings, remediation, provider details	Controlled repository; access list: [names]
Client restricted	CONTROLLED (nearest equivalent)	R2, R4, R5 reports and identifiable metrics	Named distribution: [names]
Public	PUBLIC	Anonymised research outputs; R8 Public Summary	Only after §12 approval

- ☐ AIDCF-PIL-003 default classifications accepted; the evidence lead may raise, never lower, a default.
- ☐ Redaction keeps a controlled master and never removes the decision state, controlling Gate Results, US4/US5 UNKNOWN Records or material limitations (RAS-REQ-012).
- ☐ AI-assisted tools: [not used / used only on host-approved systems: list]; outputs treated as derived evidence (E7) with lineage.
- ☐ No pilot evidence, workpaper or identifiable result is committed to the public AIDCF repository (PIL-REQ-011).

10. Data retention and destruction

Record	Holder	Retention period	At end of retention
Evidence copies	[host]	[period set by host policy]	[destroy / return]; certificate: [yes/no]
Workpapers WP-01 to WP-20 and the decision package	[host and assessment organisation]	[period]	[archive / destroy]
Pilot credentials and access logs	[host]	Revoked at SG7; logs per host policy	—
Research data (control-claim log, metrics) identifiable form	[research lead]	[period]	Destroyed or anonymised
Anonymised research data	[research lead; public repository if approved]	Indefinite	—
Personal data (interview notes, names)	[holder]	[minimum needed; period]	Destroyed

- ☐ Workpapers are version-controlled and superseded versions retained for the retention period (AMH-REQ-004).
- ☐ Destruction of evidence copies held outside the host is certified to the host in writing.

11. Confidentiality, personal data and third-party material

Field	Entry
Confidentiality terms	[reference to agreement, or terms here, as drafted by legal adviser]
Personal data	[categories (for example names and roles of interviewees); purpose; lawful basis as determined by the host's data-protection adviser; minimisation]
Third-party material	[provider and OEM documents; restrictions; consents]
Export or cross-border transfer	[none / conditions]

12. Publication and anonymisation terms

Term	Agreed entry
Host named in publications?	[no (default) / yes, in the following form: ...]
Outputs that may be published after approval	[anonymised metrics; anonymised lessons and change proposals; aggregated research results; R8 Public Summary]
Outputs that are never published	Evidence, workpapers, R2, R4, R5, topology, configurations, supplier and product names, any single point of failure or weakness
Anonymisation rules	No site, location, supplier, product, network, topology or personal details; counts small enough to identify a condition are suppressed or banded; free text reviewed for identifying detail
Approval process	Host approver [name, role] sees the exact text; approval in writing; approval may be withheld
Negative and null results	Published on the same terms as positive results, subject to the same approval
Decision publication	Only as an R8 Public Summary in AIDCF-012 controlled wording with all mandatory disclosures and the non-certification note
Repository status updates	The framework owner updates whitepaper §29.4 and README pilot status only on the basis of the signed records
Withdrawal	[host's right to withdraw approval before publication; effect after publication]

13. Conflict of interest declarations

Every assessor, technical reviewer, independent reviewer, research lead and second assessor completes one row before appointment (AMH-REQ-012; APF-REQ-006).

Name	Role	Prior design, operation or advisory work on the subject in the previous assessment period	Financial or employment relationship with host or providers	Other interest	Safeguard or exclusion	Signature, date
[ ]	[ ]	[none / describe]	[none / describe]	[none / describe]	[ ]	[ ]

- ☐ No fee or reward is contingent on the decision state (APF-REQ-005).
- ☐ Where an assessor is a host employee, the self-review threat and its safeguard are recorded and will be disclosed in the statement.

14. Independent reviewer and decision authority appointment

Field	Entry
Independent reviewer	[name, organisation]
Competence	[AC-5 basis: senior assurance competence; gate and decision challenge experience]
Independence basis	[no preparation role; no self-review threat; relationship to host and team]
Scope of review	At minimum every gate that is FAIL or UNKNOWN, every US3–US5 UNKNOWN severity, every US4/US5 UNKNOWN Record and the proposed decision wording (AMH-REQ-041; SDF-REQ-020)
Access	Full access to the decision package and evidence needed to sample assertions
Acceptance statement	"I accept appointment as independent reviewer for PILOT-[nnn] and confirm the independence basis stated."
Decision authority confirmation	As §2.3; confirms independence from the assessment team and from the independent reviewer

15. Signatures

By signing, each party confirms that the host's legal adviser has reviewed this record and that the party has authority to sign.

Party	Name	Role	Signature	Date
Sponsor				
Capability owner				
Variant B provider owner(s), if any				
Decision authority				
Safety authority				
Data protection / information governance approver				
Independent reviewer				
Lead assessor				
Research lead				
Host legal adviser (review confirmed)				

16. Authorisation status (whitepaper §29.4)

Completed by the lead assessor and kept current.

Approval/result	Status	Required evidence	Reference
Sponsor authorisation	[PENDING / SIGNED]	Signed charter	§2.1, §15
Capability-owner authorisation	[PENDING / SIGNED]	Scope and evidence-access approval	§2.2, §3, §6
Safety/testing authorisation	[PENDING / SIGNED]	Rules of engagement and stop criteria	§7, §8

Approval/result	Status	Required evidence	Reference
Data/privacy/security approval	[PENDING / SIGNED]	Classification and disclosure decision	§9 to §12
Independent reviewer acceptance	[PENDING / SIGNED]	Review memorandum	§14
Execution	NOT STARTED	Workpapers and logs	AIDCF-PIL-004
Assurance Decision	NOT ISSUED	Signed decision record	AIDCF-PIL-004
Public summary	NOT AUTHORISED	Publication approval	§12